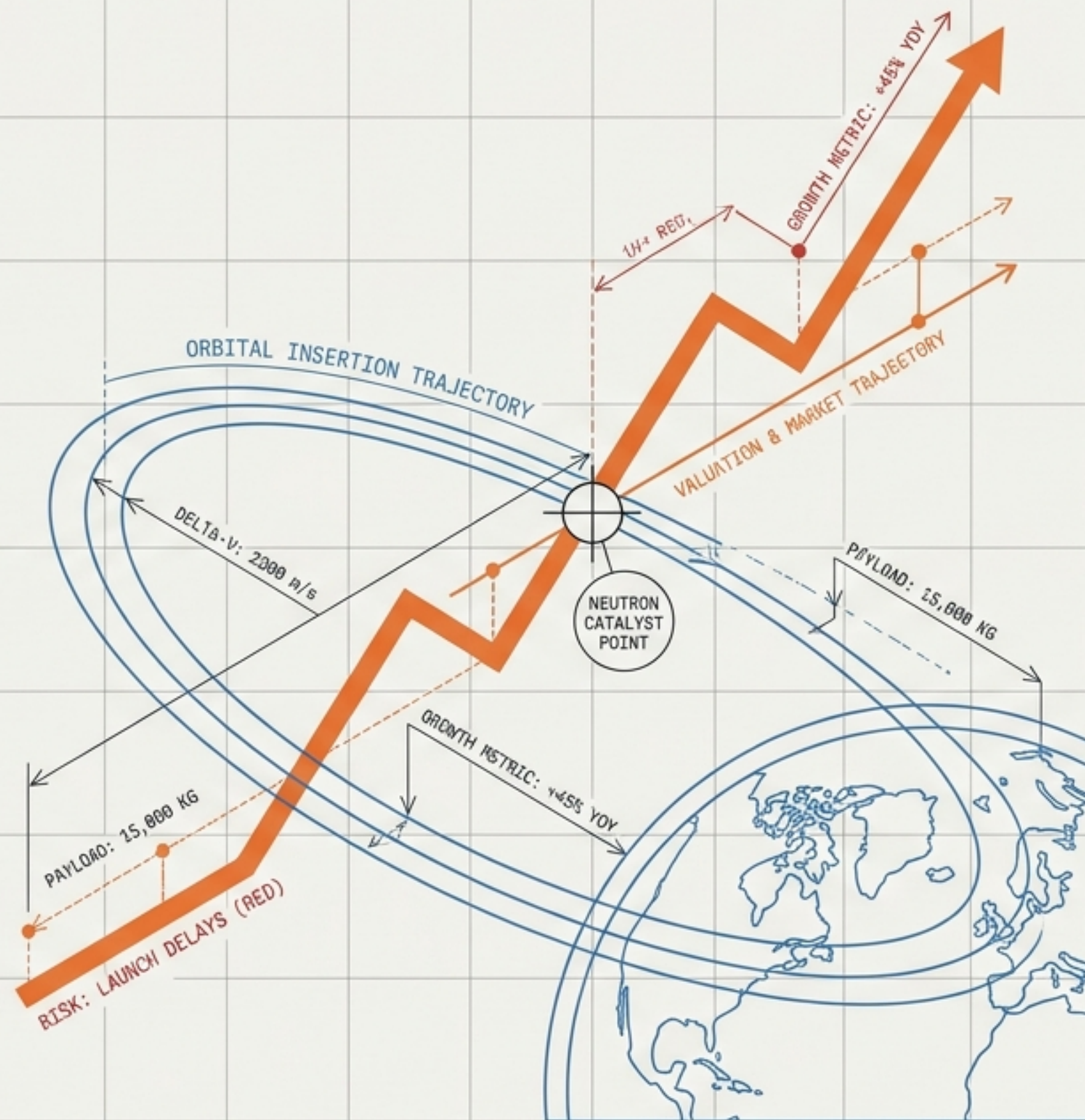


BEYOND THE SPACEX SHADOW: ROCKET LAB'S DIFFERENTIATED PLAYBOOK

ANALYZING THE MOATS,
BOTTLENECKS, AND NEUTRON
CALL OPTION OF COMMERCIAL
SPACE'S PURE-PLAY LEADER.

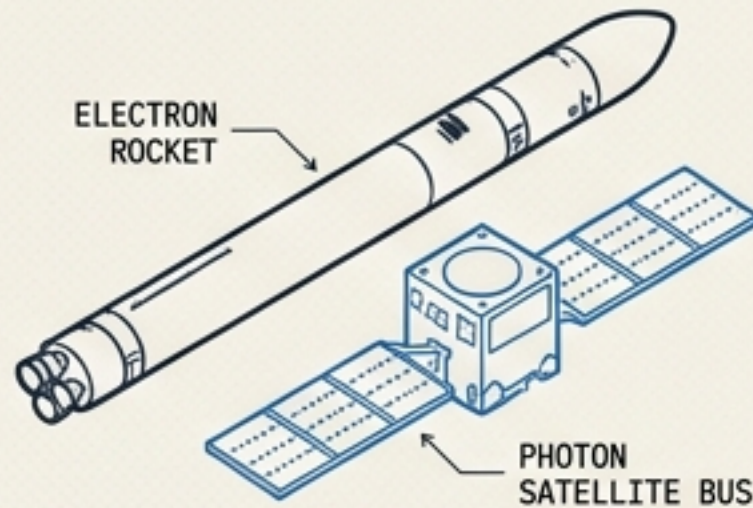
STRATEGIC ANALYSIS | COMMERCIAL SPACE
NASDAQ: RKL B | JUNE 2026



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: THE LEADER + BOTTLENECK THESIS

THE ASSET (PURE-PLAY LEADER)

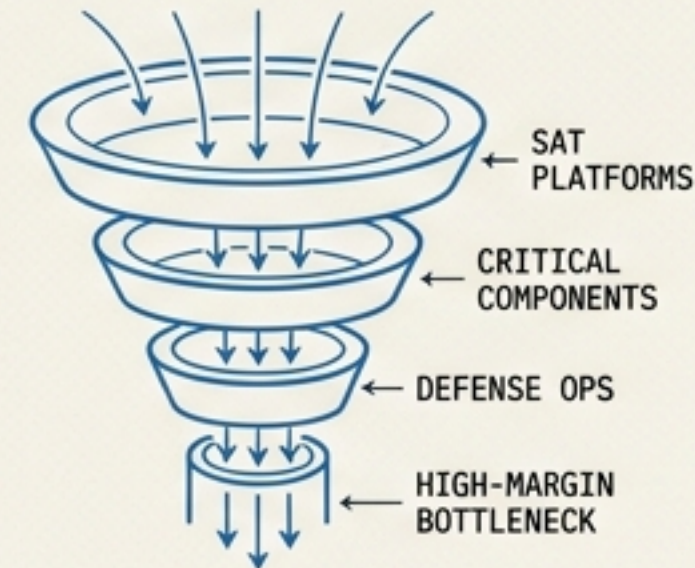
TYPE: PLATFORM | STATUS: PROVEN | TICKER: RKL B



RKL B is the highest-purity, end-to-end commercial space platform available on public markets. It combines proven launch records with a mature hardware ecosystem.

THE MOAT (SUPPLY CHAIN BOTTLENECK)

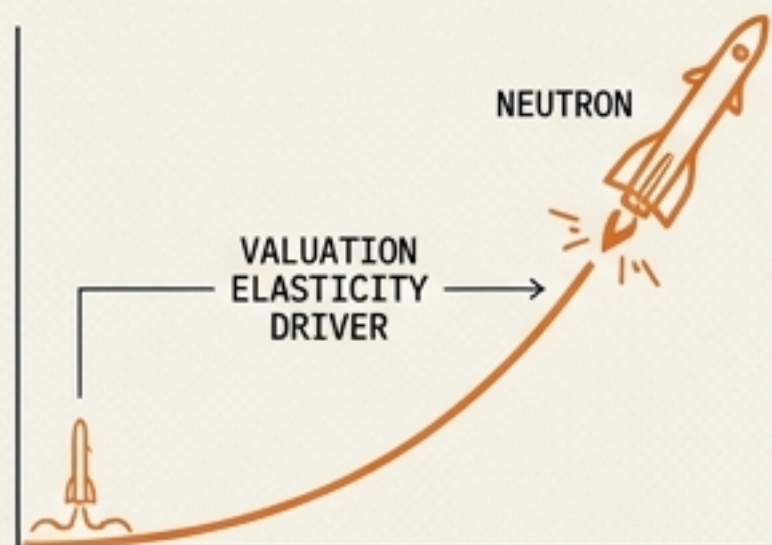
ENTRENCHMENT: HIGH | MARGINS: STICKY | FOCUS: INTEGRATION



The value is not just in rockets. RKL B's entrenched position across satellite platforms, mission-critical components, and defense operations forms a sticky, high-margin bottleneck.

THE CATALYST (THE NEUTRON OPTION)

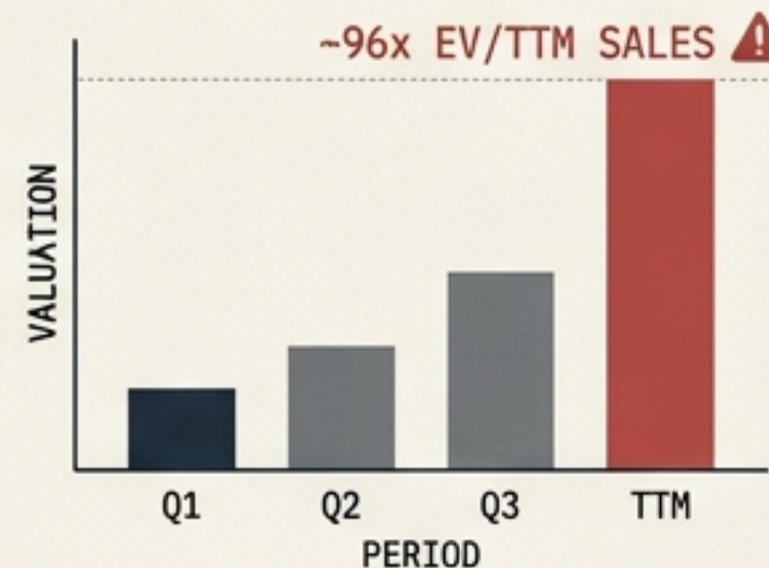
DRIVER: ELASTICITY | TARGET: NAT SEC | IMPACT: MASSIVE



The upcoming Neutron mid-lift rocket is a massive valuation elasticity driver. Success pivots RKL B into national security infrastructure.

THE REALITY (PRICED FOR PERFECTION)

EV: ~\$65.2B | EV/TTM SALES: ~96x | RISK: PREMIUM

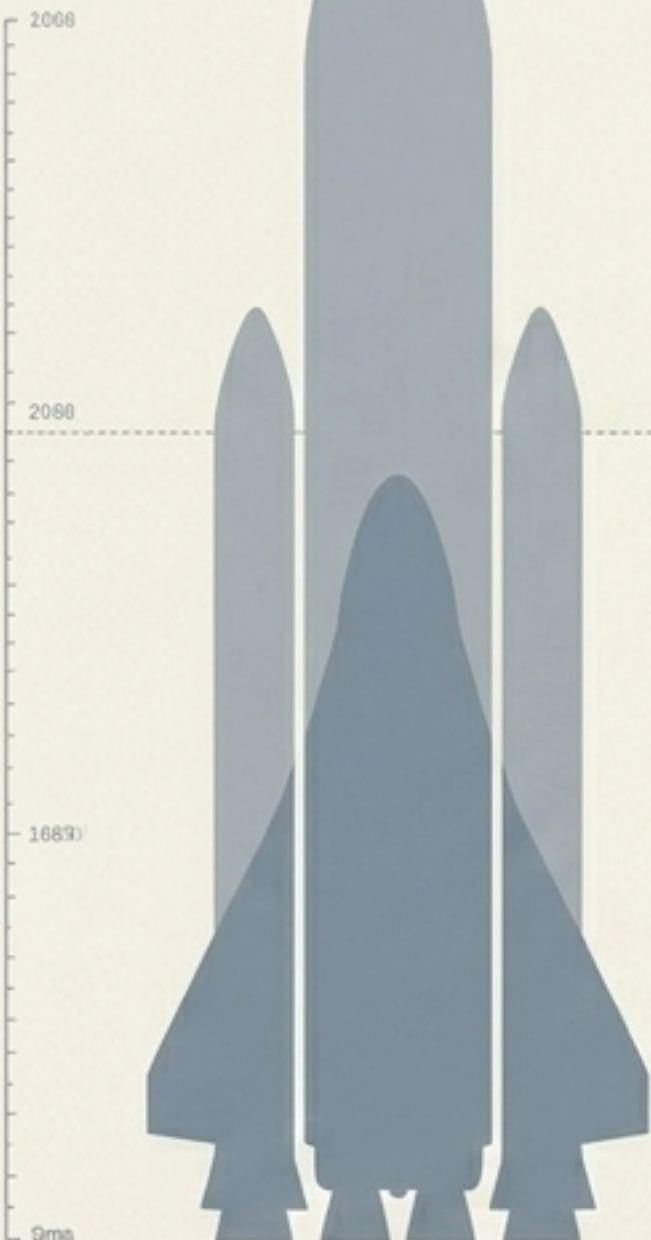


Trading at an Enterprise Value of ~\$65.2B (~96x EV/TTM Sales), the market has pre-priced significant future success. Continued premium valuation requires flawless execution.

REFRAMING THE BATTLEFIELD: THE ESSENTIAL ALTERNATIVE

THE MARKET ASSUMPTION
(DAVID VS. GOLIATH)

TYPE: B43A
TYPEL: 8080SPAG
A0661: 8080
AAIS: MILLAMETER
AAIS: X065

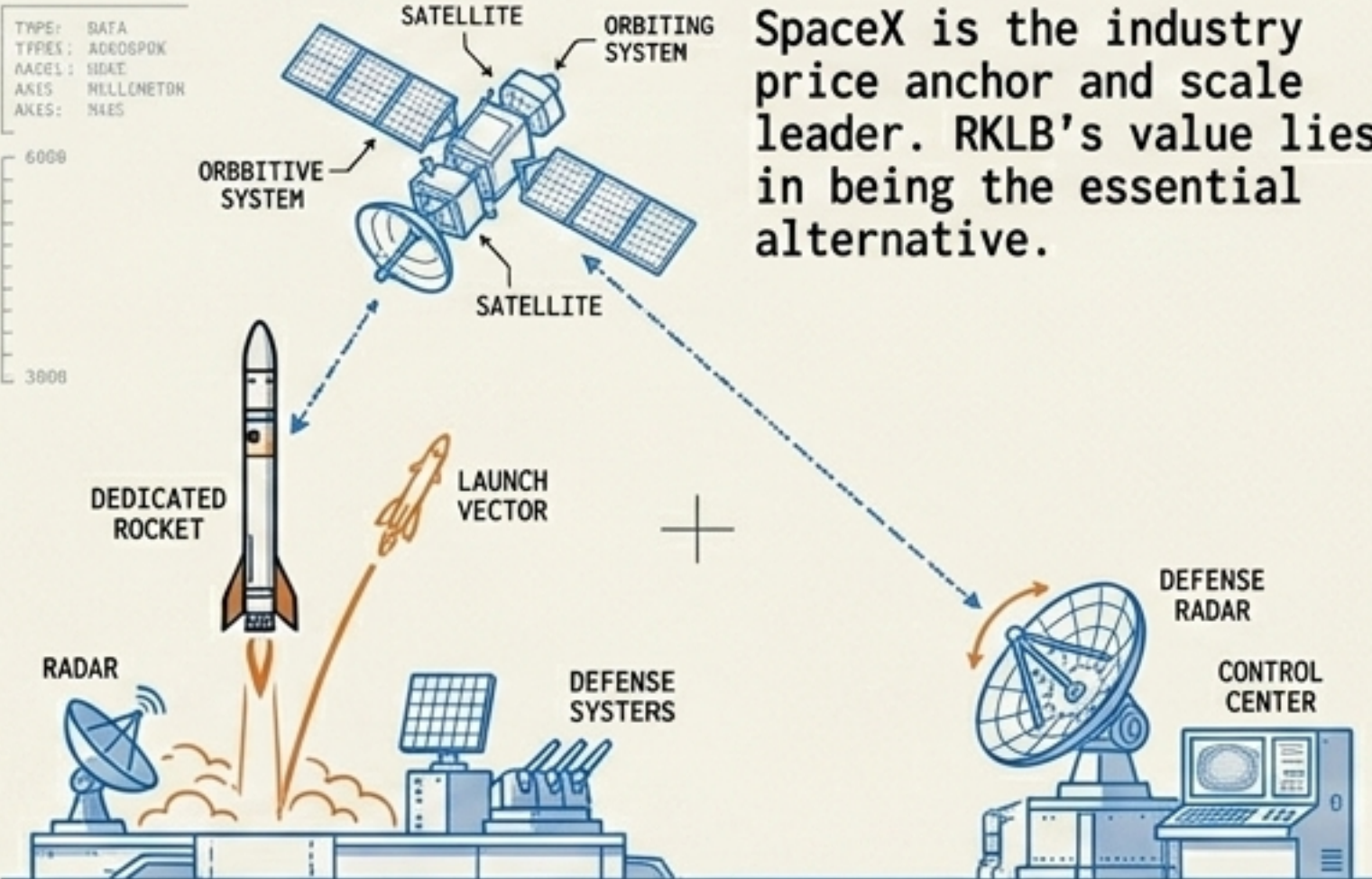


RKLB is attempting to replicate SpaceX's scale. Its survival depends on matching Falcon 9's pricing and Starlink's consumer revenue.

YIRE: T0LENGT8Z
AAIS: 2018T. 001A80
AAIS: 5.85 AAHOPEE
AAIS: 88070. 885: T06A85
AAIS: ET90667

THE STRATEGIC REALITY
(COMPLEMENTARY INFRASTRUCTURE)

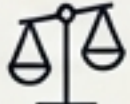
TYPE: B43A
TYPEL: 8080SPAG
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AAIS: MILLAMETER
AAIS: X065



SpaceX is the industry price anchor and scale leader. RKLB's value lies in being the essential alternative.

SpaceX is the industry price anchor and scale leader. RKLB's value lies in being the essential alternative. They provide dedicated small-launch precision, rapid defense response capabilities, component-level integration, and an independent supply chain for clients who refuse reliance on a single monopolistic vendor.

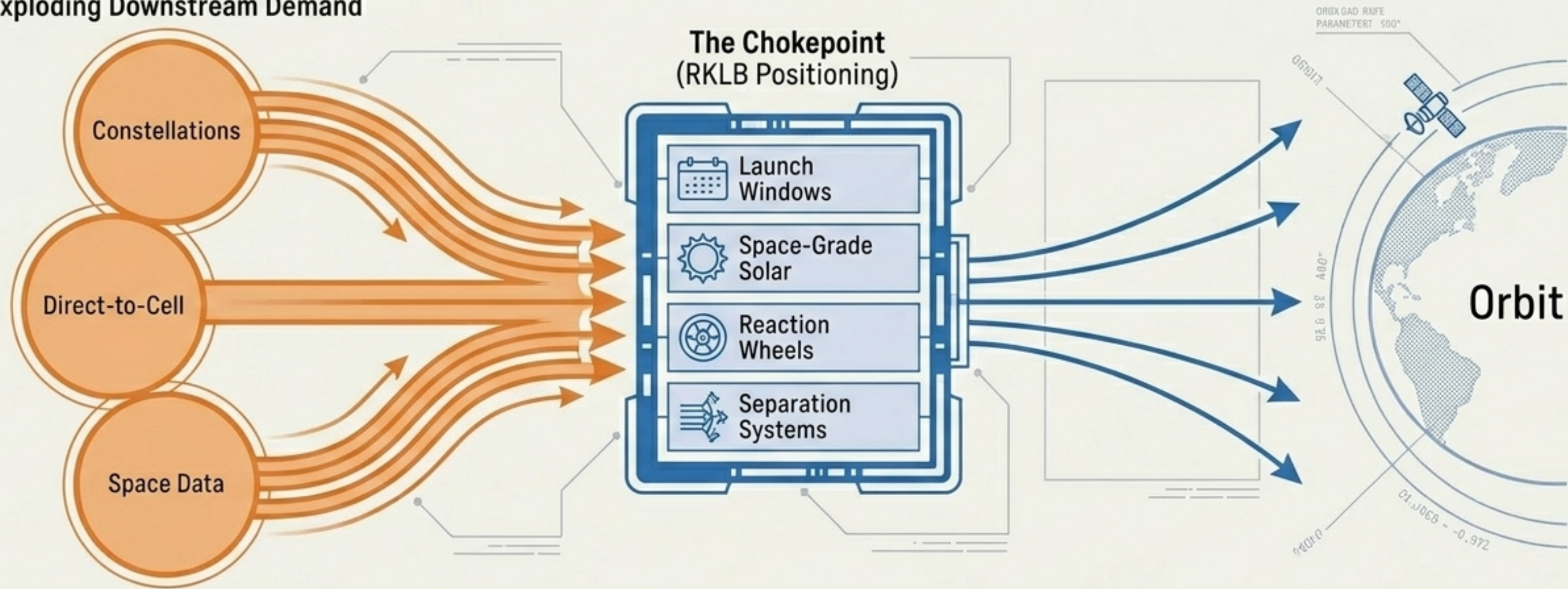
COMPETITIVE DIFFERENTIATION MATRIX

	TECH ROUTE	PRIMARY MOAT	DEFENSE POSTURE
 RKLB	Dedicated small launch + End-to-end components	Component lock-in & integrated platforms	Agile, rapid-response (HASTE)
 SpaceX	Mass rideshare + Internal mega-constellation	Unmatched scale & launch cost floor	Heavy payload & primary NSSL provider
 Blue Origin	Heavy lift focus (New Glenn)	Mega-cap backing (Amazon/Bezos)	Maturing national security infrastructure
 Traditional Defense Primes	Disaggregated systems integration	Deep incumbent government relations	Legacy large-scale defense payloads

THE COMMERCIAL SPACE BOTTLENECK

In a future supply/demand imbalance, pricing power does not go to the downstream application layer. It accrues to the mid-stream chokepoint.

Exploding Downstream Demand



Launch wins the client's initial contract; Space Systems creates immense switching costs that lock them in for subsequent constellation build-outs.



DEEP DIVE: SPACE SYSTEMS AS THE TRUE MOAT

While Launch Services generates headlines, Space Systems (TTM Gross Margins ~36.6%) holds the long-term profit pool. Flight heritage creates immense barriers to entry.

SOLAR POWER

Space-grade, high-reliability continuous power.

SEPARATION SYSTEMS

Mission-critical deployment hardware.

ATTITUDE CONTROL

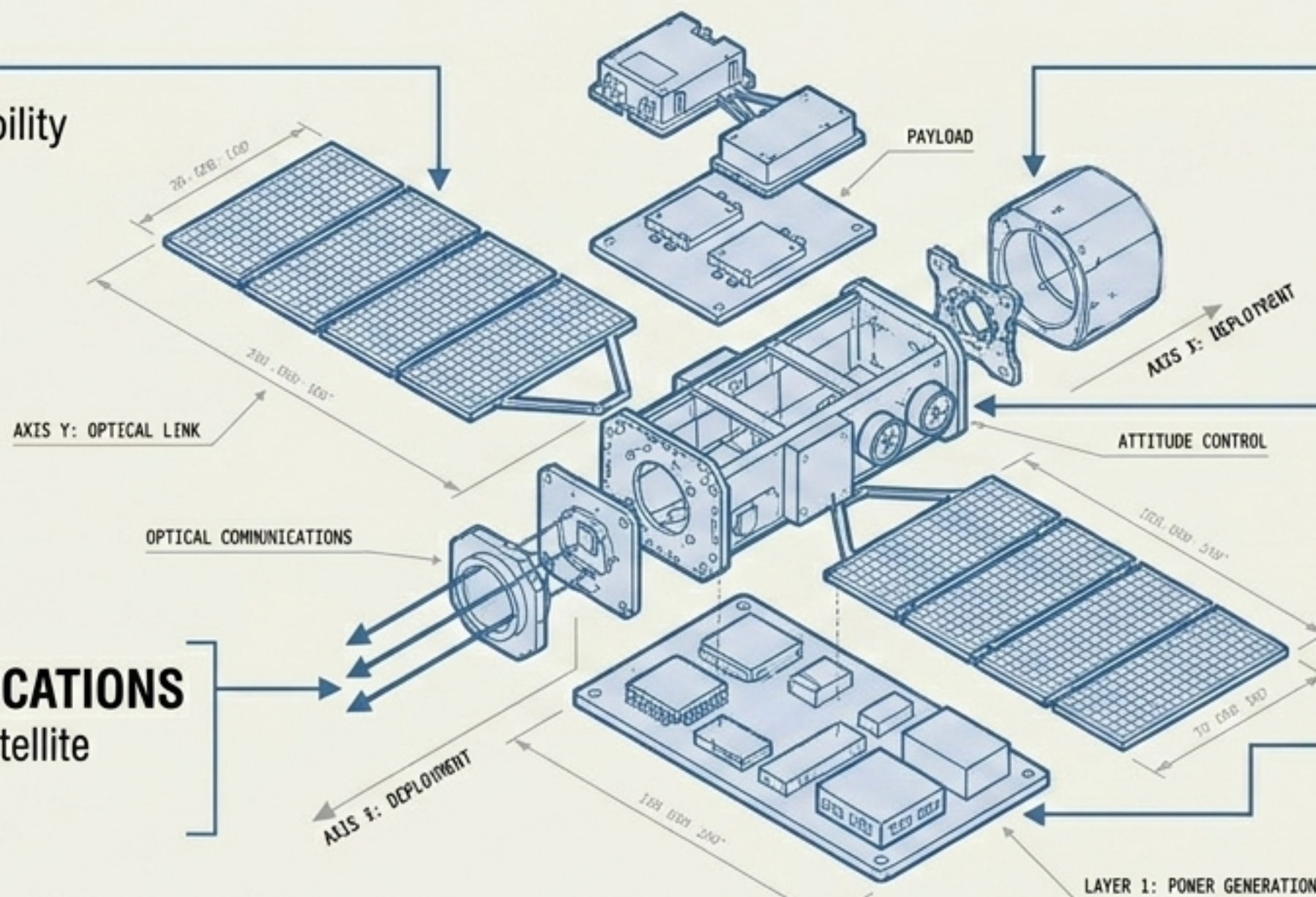
Reaction wheels for precision pointing.

OPTICAL COMMUNICATIONS

High-bandwidth inter-satellite link technology.

MISSION SOFTWARE

The operating system managing the constellation.



THE DEFENSE ANCHOR: HASTE AND NATIONAL SECURITY

Defense contracts provide lucrative, counter-cyclical revenue insulated from commercial space downturns.

HASTE CATALYST:
SUBORBITAL MISSIONS

MISSION VELOCITY: HIGH
CONTRACT VALUE: \$190M

THE HASTE CATALYST

A strategic ~20-mission, \$190M contract for the Hypersonic Accelerator Suborbital Test Electron. Elevates RKLB into high-frequency defense testing.

RIGITACT VALUE: \$190M

ORBITAL ARCHITECTURE

SUPPLY CHAIN RESILIENCE

RKLB is cementing itself as a critical node for U.S. Space Force and SDA architectures, providing a trusted, rapid-response alternative for missile defense.

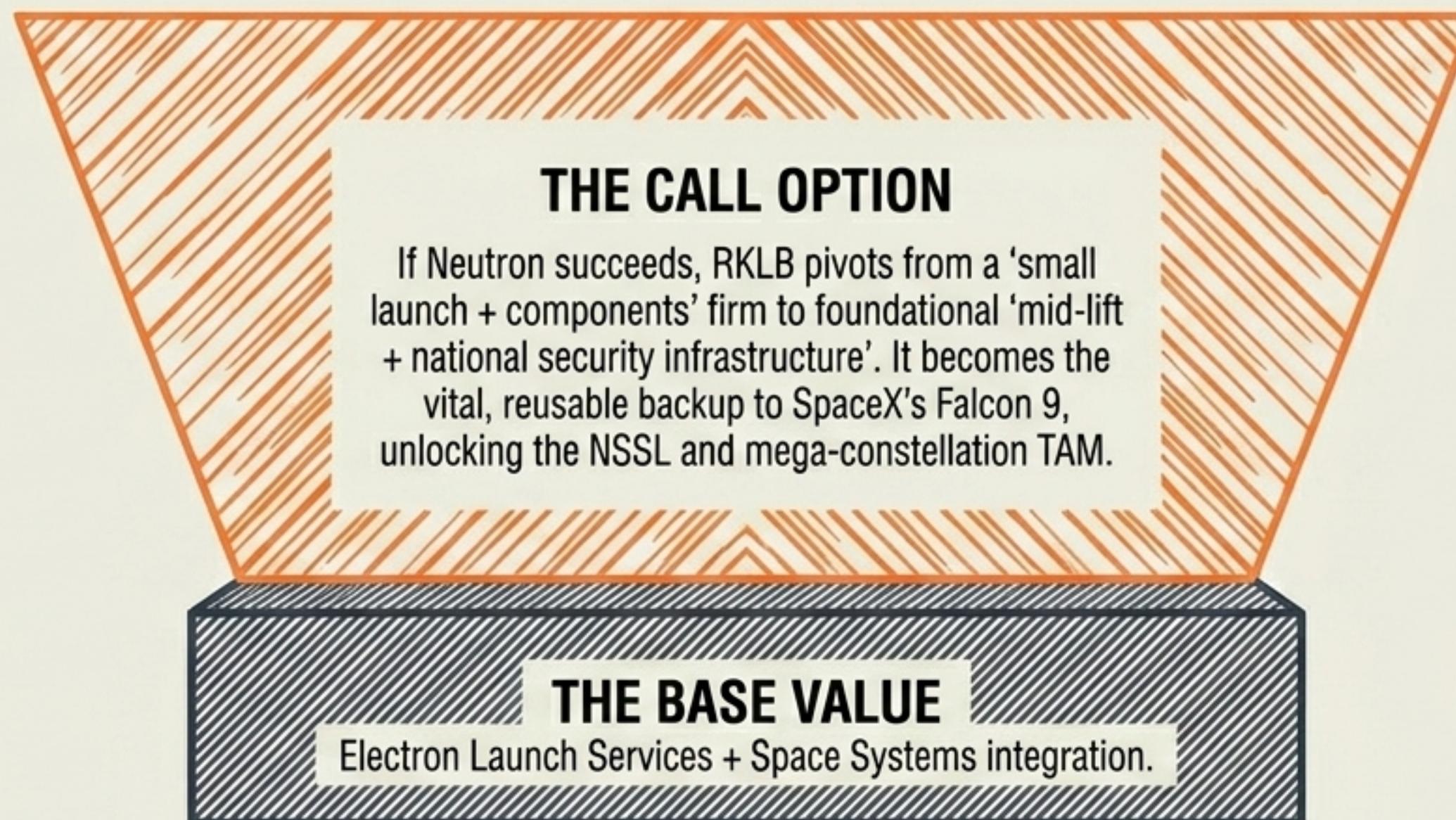
DEFENSE READINESS LEVEL

**SATELLITE DEFENSE
ARCHITECTURES**

ORBITAL ARCHITECTURE

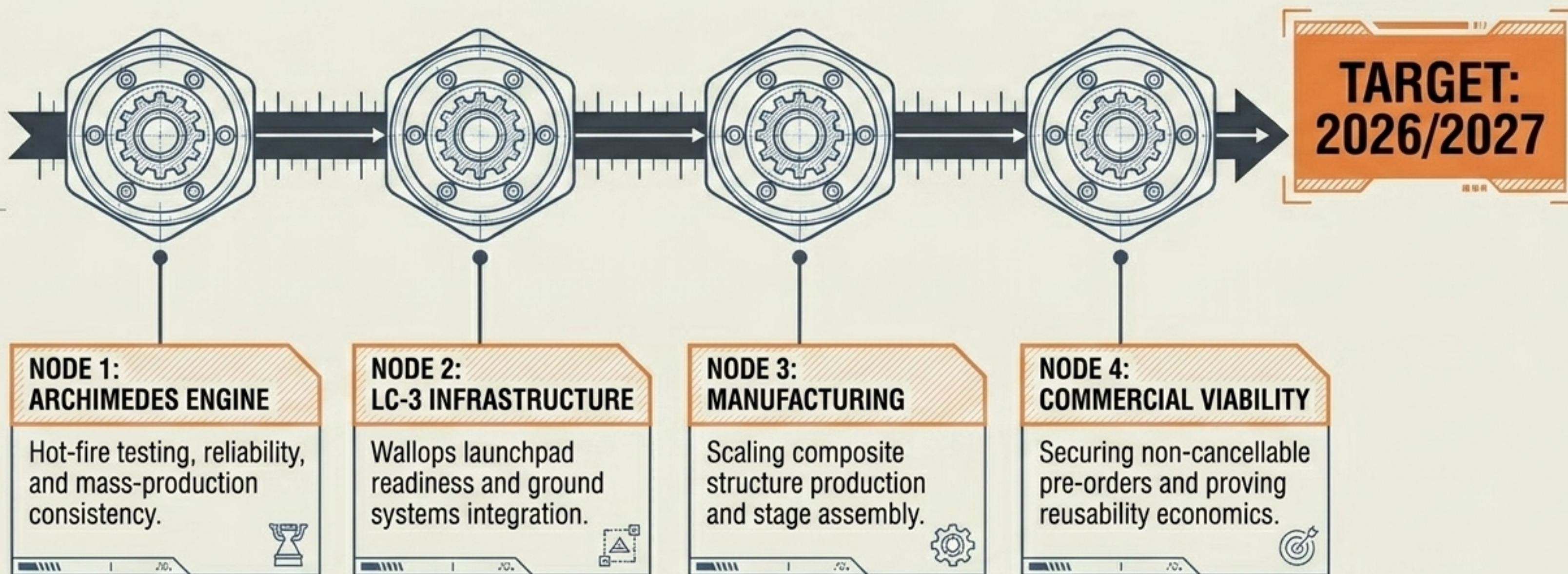
THE NEUTRON OPTION: VALUATION ELASTICITY

Electron's success proves execution, but small launch has a TAM ceiling. Neutron is the lever that breaks that ceiling.



NEUTRON EXECUTION ROADMAP

Delays along this critical path are the single biggest threat to RKL B's current premium valuation.

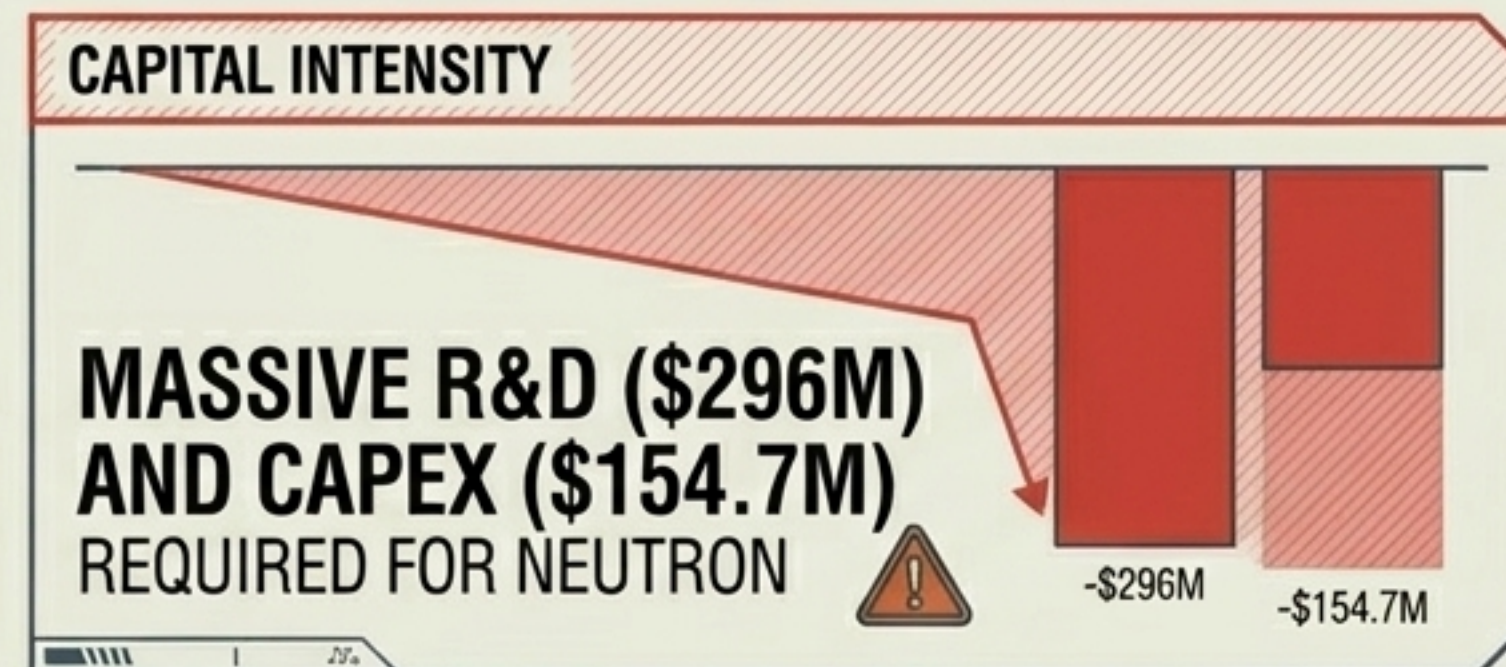
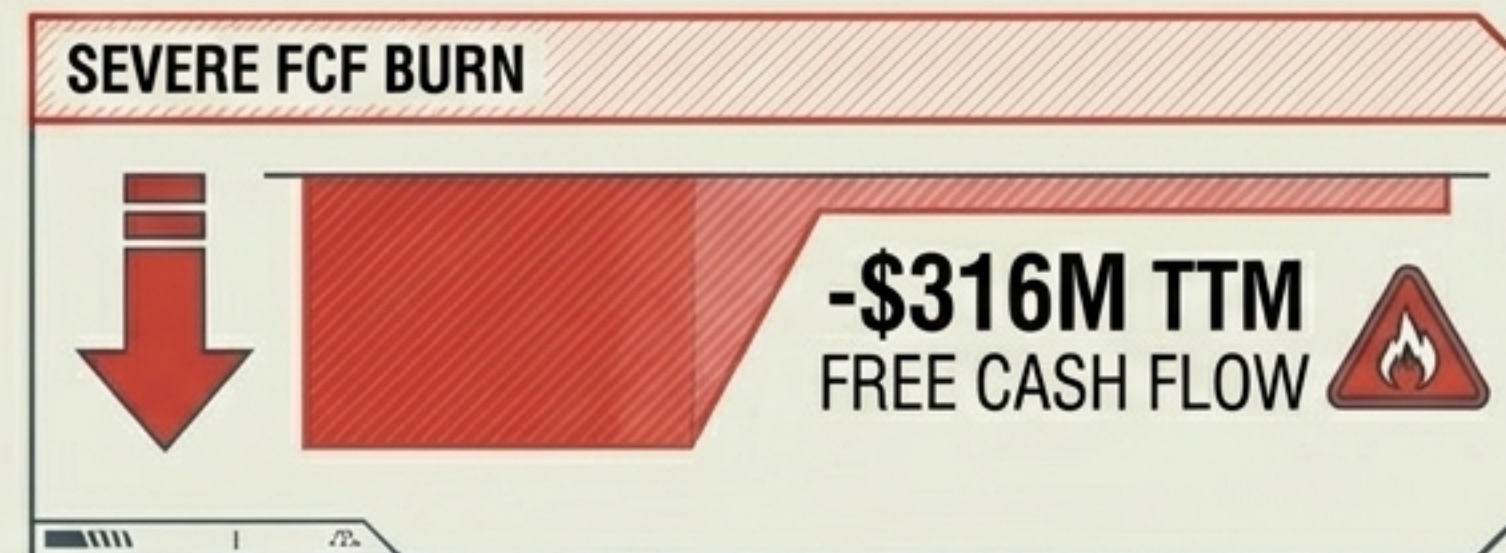


FINANCIAL SNAPSHOT: HIGH GROWTH AGAINST HIGH BURN

THE GOOD



THE BAD



VALUATION REALITY CHECK: PRICED FOR PERFECTION

At a ~\$66.4B Market Cap (~96x EV/Sales), RKL B trades entirely on future state assumptions, not current fundamental value.

BULL SCENARIO

(Multiple Holds)

Neutron flies on schedule; defense contracts scale. RKL B is cemented as the definitive "SpaceX alternative."

The high premium is maintained by immense TAM expansion.

BASE / NEUTRAL SCENARIO

(Multiple Compresses)

Electron and Systems grow steadily, but Neutron suffers standard delays.

Valuation compresses toward traditional industrial growth multiples.

BEAR SCENARIO

(Severe Rerating)

Neutron fails or faces critical redesign; SpaceX dumps rideshare pricing to squeeze margins.

High-risk project valuation leads to rapid multiple contraction.

STRATEGIC RISK RADAR

TECH/EXECUTION RISK

Catastrophic failure of the Archimedes engine testing or severe Neutron timeline delays.

MARKET/COMPETITIVE RISK

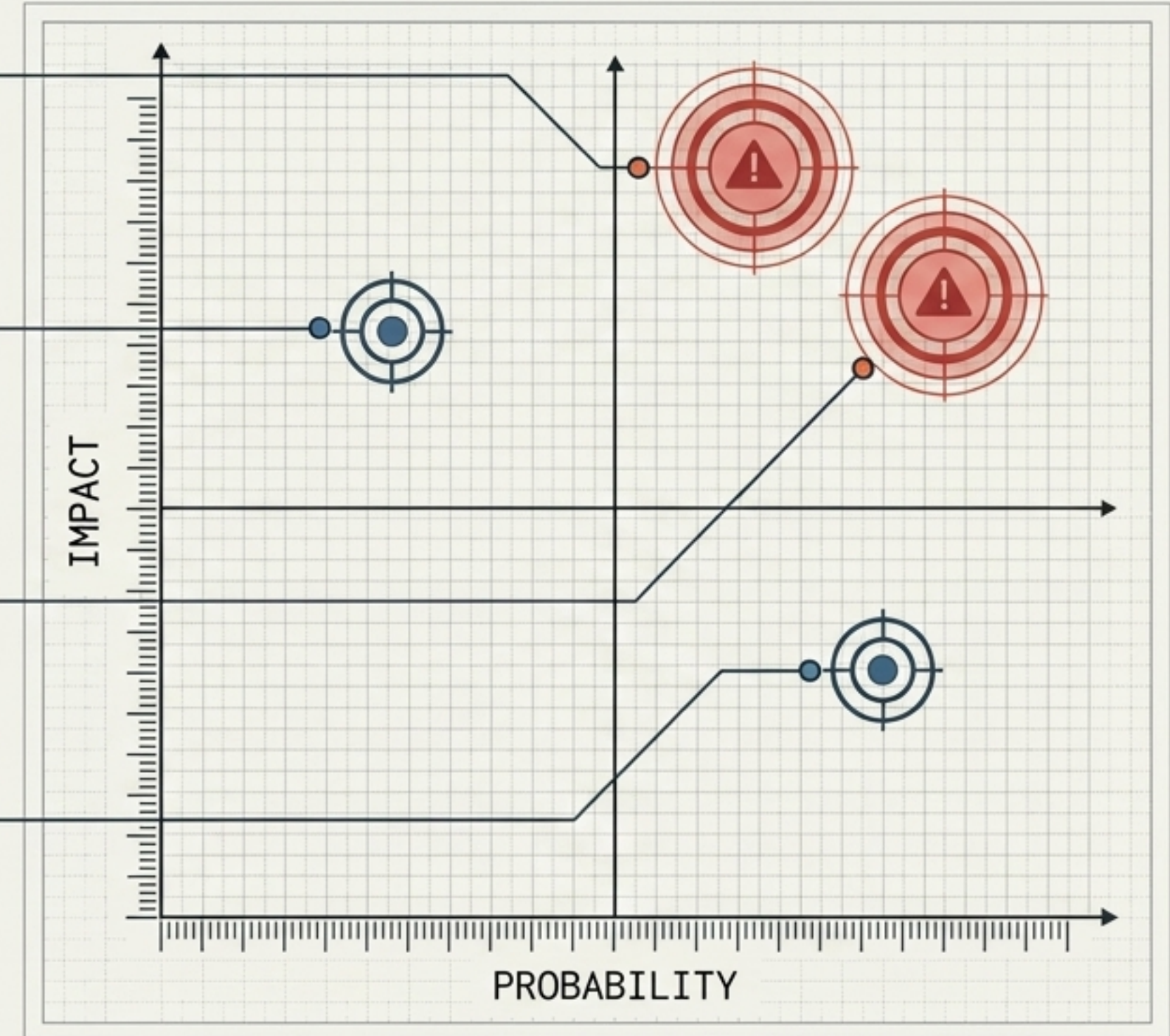
SpaceX utilizes Starlink cash flow to aggressively price-dump rideshare capacity;
Blue Origin/ULA defend NSSL share.

FINANCIAL RISK

Sustained -\$316M FCF burn forces highly dilutive equity raises during an unfavorable macro environment.

INTEGRATION RISK

Supply chain bottlenecks or failure to efficiently integrate acquired Space Systems entities damages gross margins.



STRATEGIC TRACKING METRICS (THE INVESTOR'S DASHBOARD)

Rule of Thumb: Capital allocation should follow technical node de-risking, not generic space economy hype.

